

How the Two Models Connect

The channels of the OG-Core—CLEWS soft link:
economic interpretation, model representation, and validation status

Matthew LaFleur · August 2026 · numbers from the Philippine reference run

Two models, complementary blind spots

CLEWS / OSeMOSYS

a least-cost optimiser: chooses what to build and run so energy demand is met at the lowest discounted system cost

- **rich:** technology, operation, emissions, land & water
- **blind:** demand is *fixed* — no price response, no households, no government budget, no distribution

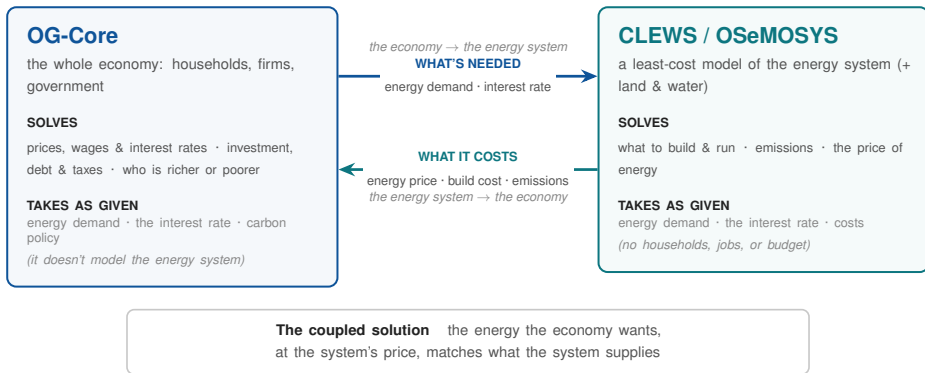
OG-Core

overlapping-generations general equilibrium: households by age $S \times$ lifetime income J , M industries, a government that closes its budget each period

- **rich:** behaviour, saving, fiscal policy, incidence, demography
- **blind:** no energy technology — energy is not a priced input to production

Each is detailed exactly where the other is blank, so what crosses the seam differs by direction: **quantities** flow from the economy; **prices and physical outcomes** flow from the energy system.

The structural seam



Each model is hollow exactly where the other is deep.

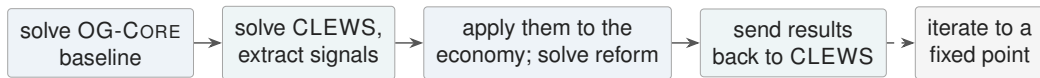
Quantities flow right (energy demand, the interest rate); prices and physical outcomes flow left (the energy price, build cost, emissions). The models stay separate and pass a small set of auditable signals.

Why a staged soft link, not one model

The classic hard-link route is foreclosed structurally:

- OG-CORE solves an overlapping-generations *transition path* period by period; OSEMOSYS is one perfect-foresight optimisation over all years at once
- hard links fold the economy in through a scalar welfare objective — and an OLG economy, an equilibrium among cohorts, has none to offer

So the link runs in stages:



Validated today: the single pass (solid) and the re-solve seam the loop requires. The outer iteration (dashed) is designed, not yet wired.

The vocabulary: signal, wedge, channel

Signal a quantity read from a *solved* CLEWS scenario: the marginal cost of a fuel, the capital a build-out requires, an emissions path, the cost implied by an emissions cap.

Wedge the OG-CORE parameter that expresses it: a consumption-price wedge τ^c , an industry productivity Z_m , the public-investment share α_I , mortality $\rho(s, t)$, effective labour $e(t, s, j)$.

Channel a named, guard-railed map from a signal to a *deliberately partitioned set of wedges that never overlap* — one wedge in the simplest channels, several where a signal splits by use (energy) or by demographic object (health).

Each channel is one small, testable mapping, and nothing country-specific is built in: which industry is electricity, and how many industries there are, is read from the country's own model at run time.

The deployed price is a levelized-cost proxy, not a marginal price

The theoretically clean signal is the marginal cost of electricity — what one more unit would cost the least-cost system to supply; under the competitive reading, the price that quantity would fetch. In this application it is *degenerate*: it binds in scattered years and is near zero elsewhere.

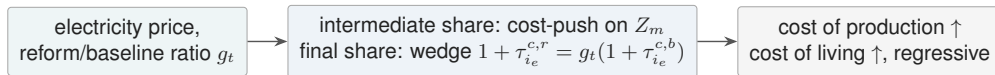
Four hygiene tests, applied before any marginal cost crosses the seam:

1. above the solver's own reporting resolution;
2. invariant across alternate optima — a price that moves while nothing physical changes is degeneracy, not information;
3. decomposed against any cost parameter that floors it;
4. traceable to a sourced input.

The electricity signal fails the first two, so the deployed price is the **levelized cost of electricity** — dense and robust; the Philippine reform raises it about 5% on average, reaching 16% by 2030.

A fixed point formed with this price is consistency under the selected proxy, not a competitive-equilibrium price.

Electricity enters through firms' costs and household budgets



- the price splits by *use*: roughly three quarters of Philippine electricity is an industry input (an input–output-calibrated cost-push on industry productivities), one quarter household consumption (a consumption-price wedge); self-use netted so nothing enters twice
- neither side alone is the channel: the wedge is close to output-neutral, the cost-push contractionary — only the composite carries the price into both margins
- with a subsistence floor, poorer households spend a larger energy share $\Rightarrow$ incidence is regressive even under full revenue recycling

The structural destination — energy as a priced production input — is specified but out of scope.

The eight channels

Channel	Dir.	Quantity entering the interface	Model representation
Energy price	C→O	reform/baseline cost ratio	industry cost-push + household wedge
Public investment	C→O	grid & transmission build cost	$\alpha_I \rightarrow K_g$
Capital intensity	C→O	fleet capital-cost share	energy industry's capital share γ_m
Health	C→O	PM _{2.5} emissions path	survival rates + effective labour
Carbon price	policy	exogenous price path	emissions penalty (energy side) + optional household wedge
Investment incentive	policy	tax-credit rate	user cost of capital
Discount rate	O→C	equilibrium return	planning-rate input
Energy demand	O→C	activity (Y_m or C_i)	annual demand path

four carry the energy system into the economy · two are policy levers · two return the economy's answers

Carbon costs enter once

Design

- energy side: an emissions penalty changes technology costs and the optimal build
- economy side: a household wedge can price direct carbon content, with revenue recycled
- one price, once — never also read back from the energy model's own implied carbon cost

Provenance checked in the case's own compiled solver input: `EmissionsPenalty` is empty in both the baseline and reform runs.

In the application (verified)

The Philippine reform solve carries *no* emissions penalty — it is a policy-composition scenario — so **no carbon price acts in the reported coupled numbers**. The flagship run *emits* a \$50/tCO₂ input for the energy model's next solve; the -0.021% standalone result is the household-wedge experiment run by itself.

Three capital mechanisms act on different equations

Mechanism	Economic object	Model entry	Interpretation
Public investment	grid and transmission	$\alpha_I \rightarrow K_g$	productive public capital; debt financing can crowd out private investment
Capital intensity	production factor mix	energy-industry γ_m	changes factor shares, unit cost, and the electricity price
Investment incentive	private capital incentive	tax credit in the user cost	shifts private capital demand toward generation

The capital-share lever and the investment incentive are *not* interchangeable views of one

build-out: they act on different equations, can move energy capital in opposite directions, and the accounting discipline forbids stacking them. Public and private capital are distinct objects — coupling both is complementary, not double counting.

The model's own first-order condition settles the capital question

Under Cobb–Douglas production, energy-industry capital demand satisfies

$$K_E = \frac{\gamma_E p_E Y_E}{\rho_E}, \quad \hat{K}_E = \hat{\gamma}_E \hat{p}_E \hat{Y}_E$$

(the user cost ρ_E and taxes cancel in the reform/baseline ratio).

Raising the capital *share* does not pull capital in: the higher exponent cuts unit cost, the electricity price collapses, and revenue — hence capital — falls, despite higher output. The instrument that does draw capital in is the tax credit, which enters ρ_E where γ_E is absent.

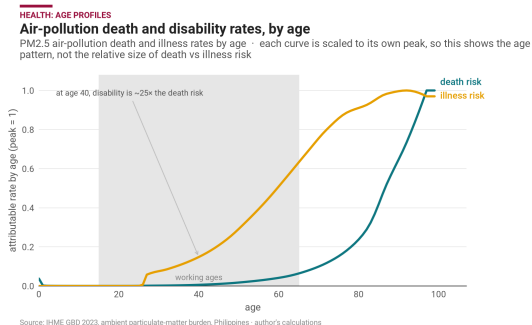
Earlier M=8 steady-state solve	Change
capital exponent γ_E	+12.2%
electricity price p_E	−42.8%
electricity output Y_E	+20.9%
electricity capital K_E	−22.4%
identity gap	0.023 pp

Evidence status: recomputed from the archived solved steady states (2026-08-04); a re-run under the re-blessed baseline is queued.

Health enters through survival and effective labour

- CLEWS supplies the PM_{2.5} emissions path; the Global Burden of Disease supplies the burden and its age profiles
- a calibrated dose-response scales the 2.7% emissions cut to about 95 fewer deaths per year — not the 1,165 of one-for-one scaling
- **mortality** skews elderly → saved lives add retirees → long-run output ≈ 0
- **morbidity** is working-age → effective labour rises — the near-term macro gain (+0.19%)

The morbidity productivity elasticity remains an application assumption.



The economy answers back: its return and its demand

Discount rate

The equilibrium return r_p becomes the energy system's planning rate — a harmonisation convention, not a structural equality.

Still to establish:

- social rate vs financing cost
- real/nominal and annualisation conventions
- risk and tax adjustments

Both are inert in a single pass by construction; they move the economy only once the loop iterates.

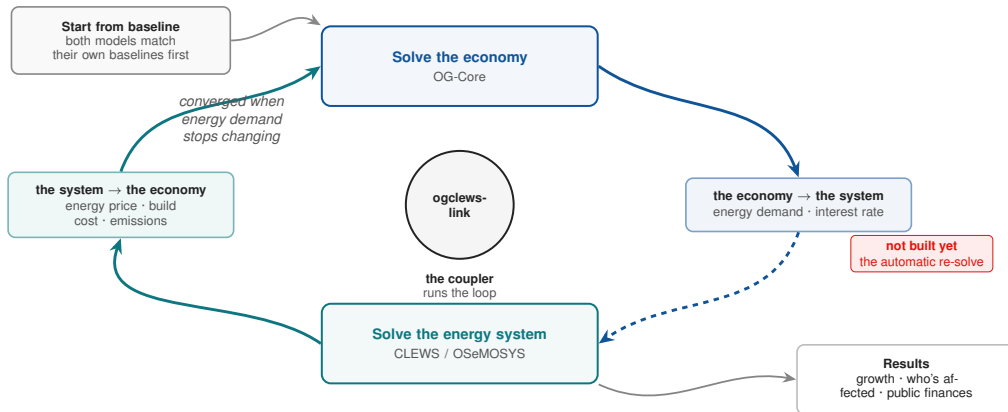
Energy demand

Sectoral output or consumption scales annual energy-service demand.

Current evidence:

- the artifact is produced after the economy solves
- a controlled +10% demand patch re-solves the energy model and raises production +4.3%
- the emitted artifact has not yet passed end to end — that is the outer controller's job

Closing the loop



Iterate until energy demand stops changing. The re-solve seam is built and tested (a controlled +10% demand patch moved production +4.3%); what remains is the outer iteration and its damping.

Counting each cost once: five principles

1. **One carbon price** — an energy-side penalty and an economy-side wedge on the same path; never also inferred from the energy model's implied carbon cost.
2. **Count each energy cost once** — the energy channel partitions electricity by use, self-use netted; a second representation of the same flow is forbidden.
3. **One view of generation capital** — cost-push *or* an investment credit; the capital share is not a third interchangeable view.
4. **Revenue must be routed** — recycle or finance the mechanical wedge revenue, or a hidden fiscal expansion rides along.
5. **Public and private capital are distinct** — $\alpha_I \rightarrow K_g$ and the firm's own K touch different objects.

Enforced by guards in the code where a forbidden combination can arise within a channel, and by experiment-composition rules across channels.

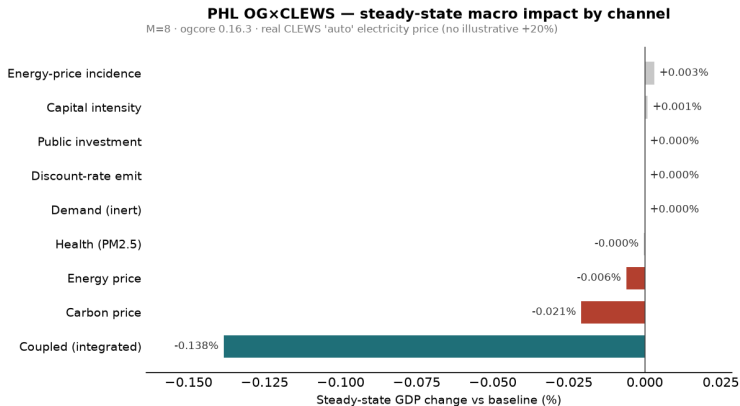
The Philippine application: what is active in the coupled run



- three mechanisms act: price, investment, health; the emitted signals are inert in one pass (no carbon price acts here)
- the steady-state total is not the sum of the standalone runs — they do not duplicate this treatment
- incidence is regressive under full recycling ($C_{ss} = -0.092\%$ in the recycled experiment)

% vs baseline	steady	t_0	t_{10}
output Y	-0.138	+0.179	+0.202
consumption C	-0.087	+0.066	+0.385

Each mechanism alone moves output little



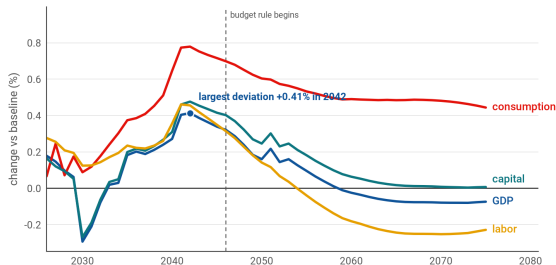
Standalone mechanism experiments, steady-state output impact (the figure’s “by channel” title predates the channel/experiment distinction). The energy price is ≈ 0 honestly transmitted; carbon (-0.021% , the household-wedge experiment) is the largest standalone contraction. Source: the committed golden record.

The coupled economy: gains along the path, costs in the long run

MACRO TRANSITION

The economy over time, vs baseline (output, consumption, capital, labor)

% change vs baseline, 2026–2075 · shows how the economy gets there over time



Source: OG-Core x CLEWS coupled model - author's calculations

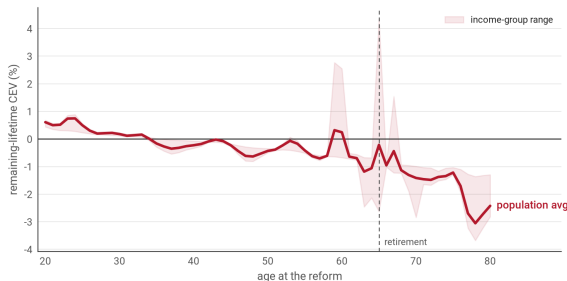
The coupled transition (% vs baseline): output +0.179% near-term, peaking about +0.4% in the early 2040s, then settling toward the -0.138% steady state as the survival gain adds retirees and energy costs persist. The horizon split is the health channel's signature and is invisible to a static model. Figure regenerated from the archived coupled run.

Who bears it: lifetime welfare by cohort

WELFARE: CEV BY AGE

Lifetime welfare effect, by current age

Welfare effect by age at the reform, averaged across income groups · ages 20–80



Source: OG-Core x CLEWS coupled model - author's calculations. lifetime CEV (consumption + labor felicity; warm-glow bequest omitted, second-order)

Remaining-lifetime welfare effect by age at the reform, with the income-group range. Younger cohorts gain (they live through the healthier transition); cohorts near and past retirement bear the cost. This cohort resolution is what the overlapping-generations side adds — no representative-agent partner can produce it. Figure regenerated from the archived coupled run.

Validation is layered, and each layer has a boundary

Evidence layer	What it establishes	Current boundary
Transform tests	shapes, bounds, concordance, fail-fast behaviour	not an economic calibration
Controlled runs	solve completion, direction, identity checks	some coefficients remain provisional
Golden record	macro aggregates stable against a committed record	excludes emitted artifacts and sectoral detail
Re-solve seam	a demand patch survives case copy, solve, read-back	no emitted artifact passed end to end
Closed-loop test	convergence and error propagation	outer controller not implemented

“Validated” never carries all five meanings at once; each claim in the paper is scoped to its layer.

Where the coupling stands

Established

- the full energy-to-economy pass on real inputs: the scenario's real electricity price, the real Global Burden of Disease data
- controlled validation evidence for the price, capital, and health mechanisms
- the re-solve seam responds correctly to a controlled demand patch
- carbon provenance in the application verified, and the reporting corrected to match

Next, in order

- the matched cumulative decomposition that reproduces the coupled run
- regression tests for the emitted artifacts
- the capital re-run under the re-blessed baseline
- the damped outer controller — loop closure
- the unit bridge, before any submission

One line: a small, auditable library of economic mechanisms — each signal counted once, each claim scoped to its evidence.